LANDING BLOWS



After CM **Revanth Reddy** alleged in the Telangana assembly that his predecessor and Bharat Rashtra Samithi chief K. Chandrashekar Rao's family had amassed properties worth Rs 1 lakh crore, the latter's son, **K.T. Rama Rao** (KTR), stumped everyone by saying the family would hand it all over to Revanth for just Rs 1,000 crore. Calling out the "baseless charges", he quipped that the remaining Rs 99,000 crore could then be used to fulfil the Congress's pending poll promises to farmers and women. The CM has now ordered a survey of the land around KCR's Erravelli farmhouse to "establish the facts".

SINGLE REQUEST



Wedding preparations are in full swing at the Aligarh home of Uttar Pradesh basic education minister **Sandeep Singh**, who is tying the knot on November 14. However, on September 19, some uninvited guests landed up. OBC aspirants for the 7,000 vacant assistant teacher posts staged a protest outside Singh's Marris Road home, demanding jobs pending since 2018. The punchline was in the placards. "*Mantriji, aap to shaadishuda ho jaenge, hum berozgar kya kunware mar jayenge?* (Minister, you will soon get married, will we the unemployed die as bachelors?").

CO-OP CLOUT



Dileep Sanghani, chairman of fertiliser giant IFFCO, is going global. The ex-Gujarat minister and Lok Sabha MP was elected director-at-large on the 30-member board of the International Cooperative Alliance, which represents over 3 million cooperatives worldwide. Sanghani heads IFFCO's formidable network of 35,700 agri societies, but his influence does not flow from Delhi. In IFFCO's 2024 board polls, BJP MLA from Jetpur, Jayesh Radadiya, seen as his choice, had defeated the party high command-backed Bipin Patel, vice-chairman of co-op marketing federation, Gujcomasol.

Kaushik Deka *with* Amitabh Srivastava, Prasad Nichenametla, Ashish Misra *and* Jumana Shah

HEALTH WATCH

RAILWAY STATION SANITATION
E. COLI IN DRINKING WATER

By **Sonali Acharjee**

A parliamentary panel committee last week examined a CAG audit of 512 non-suburban railway stations that had found serious gaps in sanitation and passenger amenities, including E. coli contamination in drinking water samples, poorly maintained toilets, waterlogging and overflowing sewerage systems. Water coolers at eight stations had tested positive for E. coli, raising concerns about faecal contamination and the risk of water-borne diseases.

E. coli is commonly present in the intestines of humans and animals and, while many strains are harmless, its presence in drinking water is an indicator that the supply may have been contaminated by faecal matter. Disease-causing strains can lead to diarrhoea, abdominal cramps and, in some cases, more severe illness. Contaminated water and poor sanitation can also increase the risk of infections such as typhoid and hepatitis A and E, all of which spread through the faecal-oral route.

For passengers, experts say the safest approach is to choose factory-sealed bottled water, and to check that the seal is intact before drinking. Ice and beverages made with unverified water are best avoided, while water used for brushing teeth should also come from a safe source. Hand hygiene is equally important, particularly after using station toilets and before eating. The larger concern here is that contaminated water often does not look or smell bad. The Railways must get its act together, make safe drinking water top priority at stations and on trains. Regular testing of water samples will go a long way in ensuring this.



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